

Poems for website

Our Tree

Six years ago I'd walk outside to a tree
Just barely tall enough to ride a rollercoaster
I greeted him every morning
And he back to me

On Saturday, my mum would water him
Her tattered straw hat deteriorating in the wind
As the days went by he didn't seem to be growing
But the small increments were blinded by frequency

Soon he was taller than me
We'd relax in his shade
The cat scratching at his trunk
The dog chewing a cardboard box

Three years later he was taller than the house
Wider than my two siblings and I combined
And grew a pineapple-shaped ring at his crown
Which soon became home to families of sparrows

They loved the tree and so did we
They played and grew under his fronds
Just as we did
A few feet below

On Sunday morning my mum would cook eggs
And with a new straw hat she'd water the plants
As we sat and ate under the symphony of sparrows
Talking about how much better tangerine juice is than orange

That next year I went off to college
I said goodbye to my mum
I said goodbye to the birds
And I said goodbye to the tree

My new home didn't have a straw hat
Didn't have a hyper dog or a cocky cat
And sure, it had birds
But they didn't sing the song of our tree

I returned from college chubbier than when I left
The tree laughed and I did too
It seemed as I got larger so did he
And it was nice feeling known

One Sunday breakfast
The tangerine juice turned sour
The cardboard box was left untouched
And the birds sang out of key

The tree's arms had begun to brown and wilt
And with each new day a new degree down
We tried method after method to cure him
But nothing seemed to work

Our tree
Our friend
Our guardian
Diseased
Had begun to die

He said there was no use in crying
All things must die and so must I
And yes he was young
But this was always his fate

An arborist came and we said goodbye
He smiled like he always did
And shortly after he was cut down
Returned to the earth

The birds flew confused looking for their home
The song of panic replaced the song of joy
The cat's nails grew so he used the couch

And the view outside felt empty without him

But that next week

On Sunday morning

The tangerine juice turned sweet again

And I smiled

Knowing he was

Too

A Reservoir of Lost Art

It's raining on all the books and magazines
It seems no one reads
Scrolling through an endless feed
Of people they'll never meet

Fake asses
Fake lips
Fake trips
Fake fun
Life blowing them by in a blip
Until
One day
They crap up and die
Having lived
A fake life

It's raining on all the books and magazines
The text begins to drip and bleed
A deep puddle of thick black ink
Incoherent
Indecipherable
A reservoir of lost art

Requirements

Some people require

Attention

Impressions

Jests

Plans

Theatrics

Hierarchy

Narratives

Calm.

D

O

W

N

Seriously.

I hope this structure

Pis ses

Y

O

U

F

OF-

Five Lost Boys

We walk barefoot
not an hour before sunset
to an abandoned staircase
laden with warnings of its danger.
We hop the gate and begin our descent,
down the rows of grey stones
and into the gorge below.

The rustling of the trees
the beating of our bare feet
the rush of the stream
and the unaltered song of the mourning doves,
creates a forestal symphony
we have become addicted to hearing.

The forbidden nature of this spot allures;
we feel rebellious,
we feel accepted,
we feel seen,
we feel rich.

The sunset clouds turn peach pink
illuminating the land far past its rest.
In this light, the gorge gains a new character
as the mist from the waterfalls now becomes visible.

The water rushes past our feet
with decisive forward motion
providing reassurance that life moves on
and that the past is non defining.

The warm summer rain satiates the air
with the smell of freshly watered soil.
Unevaporated droplets still reside on the lower leaf;
they drip down onto our foreheads,
and run down our faces.

As the peach sky of the sunset fades
the light blue of the early moon comes in its wake.
Its distant glow is inviting.
Its simple shape is soothing

In its presence,
I beckon and I want
I release repressed emotions,
speak without restraint,
and discover more about who I am.

We come to this place
to release energy;
We come to this place
to overcome ourselves.

Under the influence of everyday tasks,
under the curtain of everyday sites,
we are reserved.
Not because we desire to be seen as tough,
but because we are scared of vulnerability.

Like the first flower to rise in April,
Wondering if the sun will provide it life,

Here, we forget about that.
For nature is in itself vulnerable
and in this vulnerability lies great strength
which then begins to flow through us.

Nature always understands you
Better than yourself.
Open your ears and listen to its advice.
Calm your mind and think in its silence.
Unclench your fists and yell in its greatness.
Open your heart and love in its beauty.

There's more to learn from things that don't speak
than from those that do.

